

A N S W E R K E Y

Appropriate Use of Force — BSIS Certification

Instructor Copy — Retain Securely — Do Not Leave Unattended

32 Questions | Pass: 100% | BPC §7583.7

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL ANSWERS

32 Q | Pass: 100%

Q1	B	Q2	B	Q3	C	Q4	B	Q5	C
Q6	B	Q7	B	Q8	C	Q9	C	Q10	B
Q11	B	Q12	C	Q13	B	Q14	C	Q15	C
Q16	C	Q17	B	Q18	B	Q19	B	Q20	B
Q21	B	Q22	C	Q23	B	Q24	C	Q25	B
Q26	B	Q27	B	Q28	B	Q29	C	Q30	B

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Legal Standards

BPC §7583.7

The standard applied to evaluate a security guard's use of force under California law is:

- A. Whatever force the guard personally deemed necessary
- ✓ B. Objectively reasonable force under the circumstances
- C. Whatever force the client contract authorizes
- D. Whatever force prevents injury to the guard

B

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Legal Standards

BPC §7583.7

Which of the following creates BOTH criminal and civil liability for a guard's use of force?

- A. Any use of physical contact
- ✓ B. Force that is excessive or unreasonable under the circumstances
- C. Force authorized in writing by the property owner
- D. Force used to stop property theft

B

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Legal Standards

BPC §§7583.2, 7583.4, 7574.37

After a use-of-force incident, a security guard is required to:

- A. Notify the client and take no further action
- ✓ C. Complete a written incident report and notify their PPO supervisor
- B. Wait for the supervisor to file all paperwork
- D. File the report within 72 hours at their discretion

C

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Legal Standards

Contractual Obligations

A security guard's use-of-force authority may be FURTHER RESTRICTED (beyond California law) by:

- A. The guard's personal level of training
- ✓ B. The property owner's contract with the PPO
- C. BSIS directly overriding any contract
- D. State law — contracts cannot restrict authorized force

B

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Objectively Reasonable Force

Graham v. Connor

'Objectively reasonable force' is evaluated from the perspective of:

- A. A legal expert reviewing the incident afterward
- ✓ C. A reasonable officer at the scene with the same information
- B. The supervisor who approved the guard's assignment
- D. The property owner who contracted for security services

C

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Objectively Reasonable Force

BPC §7583.7(b)(2)

In the force continuum, which response should always be attempted first?

- A. Physical restraint to gain immediate control
- ✓ B. Verbal commands and de-escalation communication
- C. Drawing any available weapon to establish compliance
- D. Calling law enforcement before taking any action

B

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*Objectively Reasonable Force**BPC §7583.7(b)(2)*

A guard applies a pain compliance hold on a cooperative subject who simply declined to show ID. This force is:

- A. Lawful — compliance with ID checks can be enforced physically
- C. Lawful if permitted in the client contract

- ✓ **B. Potentially excessive — the situation did not justify that level of force**
- D. Required protocol for non-compliant subjects per BSIS

B

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*Objectively Reasonable Force**Force Continuum*

Force used against a person must be reduced or stopped when:

- A. The subject verbally protests the force being used
- ✓ **C. The threat that justified the force no longer exists**

- B. The guard's supervisor arrives on scene
- D. The guard has documented the incident in their radio log

C

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*Duty to Intercede**BPC §7583.7(b)(3)*

The duty to intercede requires a security guard to:

- A. Step in to manage any physical altercation that occurs on their post
- ✓ **C. Stop or attempt to stop another guard who is using clearly excessive force**

- B. Report all use-of-force incidents to BSIS within 24 hours
- D. Contact law enforcement before personally taking any action involving the incident

C

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*Duty to Intercede**BPC §7583.7(b)(3)*

A guard witnesses their coworker continue striking a handcuffed, compliant subject. The correct response is to:

- A. Document the incident and raise it in the next staff meeting
- C. Defer to the senior guard's judgment — they may know something you do not

✓ **B. Intervene immediately to stop the excessive force, then report the incident**

- D. Notify only the client — BSIS reporting is the PPO's responsibility

B

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*Supervisory Responsibilities**BPC §§7583.2, 7583.4*

A supervisor's obligation after a guard under their command uses force includes:

- A. Reviewing the report at end of week only if injury occurred
- C. Notifying the client only — BSIS reporting is optional for minor incidents

✓ **B. Filing a full incident report per BPC §§7583.2 and 7583.4 required**

- D. Verbal documentation — written reports are only needed for firearm incidents

B

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*Supervisory Responsibilities**BPC §7574.37*

Which statute requires a PPO to report use-of-force incidents to BSIS?

- A. BPC §480

✓ **C. BPC §7574.37**

- B. PC §837

- D. Title 16 CCR §640

C

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De-escalation — 4 Concepts

BPC §7583.7(b)(6)

The four core concepts of de-escalation per BSIS training are:

- A. Run, Hide, Fight, Report
- C. Observe, Orient, Decide, Act

✓ **B. Self-control, Effective Communication, Scene Assessment and Management, Force Options**

- D. Approach, Contain, Communicate, Resolve

B

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De-escalation — 4 Concepts

BPC §7583.7(b)(6)

Which tactical methods are specifically listed in the BSIS AUF syllabus for de-escalation?

- A. Restraint and containment as primary tools
- ✓ **C. Time, distance, cover, and concealment**

- B. Force, command, distance, and exit strategy
- D. Radio, backup, cover, and reporting

C

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De-escalation — 4 Concepts

BPC §7583.7(b)(6)

A guard is facing an agitated but non-threatening subject who is yelling. The BEST first response is:

- A. Immediately request police and do not engage
- ✓ **C. Use verbal de-escalation: speak calmly, give space, listen actively**

- B. Apply restraint before the situation escalates further
- D. Request backup and assume a defensive posture without speaking

C

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De-escalation — 4 Concepts

BPC §7583.7(b)(6)

De-escalation techniques are NOT a safe primary option when:

- A. A subject is verbally hostile but not physically threatening
- ✓ C. The subject poses an immediate physical threat requiring defensive action
- B. A subject refuses to show identification when asked
- D. A subject is crying or appears emotionally distressed

C

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Bias & Cultural Competency

BPC §7583.7(b)(7)

Implicit bias in security work is best described as:

- A. Conscious, deliberate prejudice that guards are aware of
- ✓ B. Automatic, unconscious attitudes that can affect perceptions and decisions
- C. Bias found only in law enforcement — not private security
- D. A form of bias that training completely eliminates

B

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Bias & Cultural Competency

BPC §7583.7(b)(7)

Cultural competency requires security guards to:

- A. Apply identical procedures to all persons without modification
- ✓ B. Recognize and adapt communication strategies for diverse communities while maintaining equal enforcement
- C. Apply heightened scrutiny to individuals from unfamiliar cultural backgrounds
- D. Defer all cross-cultural contacts to a supervisor

B

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Bias & Cultural Competency

BPC §7583.7(b)(7)

Explicit bias in the security context refers to:

- A. Unconscious attitudes that affect decision-making without awareness
- C. Cultural sensitivity and awareness training requirements

- ✓ **B. Deliberate, conscious prejudice that guides enforcement decisions**
- D. De-escalation techniques designed for diverse populations

B

20

Disability & Behavioral Health

BPC §7583.7(b)(8)

When a security guard encounters a person experiencing a behavioral health crisis, the FIRST priority is:

- A. Immediately contact law enforcement and maintain distance
- C. Apply early restraint to prevent the situation from escalating

- ✓ **B. Approach calmly, use de-escalation, and avoid physical force unless there is immediate danger**
- D. Treat the encounter identically to a standard criminal contact

B

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Disability & Behavioral Health

ADA | BPC §7583.7(b)(8)

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) requires security guards to:

- A. Apply an identical enforcement standard to all persons without any modification
- C. Refer all ADA-related questions directly to the property owner

- ✓ **B. Provide reasonable accommodation and modified communication approaches for persons with disabilities**
- D. Restrict application of trespass law to persons with disabilities

B

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Disability & Behavioral Health

BPC §7583.7(b)(8)

A key communication strategy when interacting with a person who may have a cognitive disability is:

- A. Use precise legal terminology to clearly define their obligations
- ✓ C. Use plain language, be patient, and avoid issuing multiple commands at once

- B. Speak more loudly and repeat commands with increasing firmness
- D. Immediately request police assistance for any interaction involving disability

C

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Scenario Training

BPC §7583.7(b)(9)

The primary purpose of shoot/don't-shoot scenario training is to develop a guard's ability to:

- A. Improve aim and accuracy with a firearm
- C. Practice verbal command delivery in high-stress settings

- ✓ B. Make real-time, accurate force decisions under stress with available information
- D. Demonstrate de-escalation to an evaluating instructor

B

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Scenario Training

BPC §7583.7(b)(9)

Before using force in a dynamic situation, a guard should consider all of the following EXCEPT:

- A. The immediacy and nature of the threat
- ✓ C. The property owner's stated preference for how force is handled at this location

- B. Distance available and availability of cover
- D. Whether a lower level of force would resolve the situation effectively

C

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Mental Health & Active Shooter

BPC §7583.7(b)(10)-(11)

In an active shooter situation, a security guard's primary role is to:

- A. Confront and neutralize the shooter to protect the property
- C. Conduct a perimeter search to locate the shooter before police arrive

✓ **B. Protect lives, coordinate evacuation, and support law enforcement response**

- D. Pursue the shooter throughout the facility to prevent harm

B

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Mental Health & Active Shooter

BPC §7583.7(b)(11)

The first priority when an active shooter situation is confirmed is:

- A. Securing the building perimeter
- C. Drawing a firearm and moving toward the threat

✓ **B. Protecting and evacuating occupants — prioritizing the RUN protocol**

- D. Waiting for explicit police instructions before taking any action

B

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Mental Health & Active Shooter

BPC §7583.7(b)(10)

Mental health stigma in security contexts can cause guards to:

- A. Under-respond to persons with mental illness by assuming they are less dangerous
- C. Have no obligation to consider a subject's mental health in a use-of-force analysis

✓ **B. Over-respond and use excessive force based on unfounded assumptions about mental illness**

- D. Apply an identical force response to all persons regardless of mental health status

B

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Mental Health & Active Shooter

BPC §7583.7 | BPC §631

The categories of mental illness that security guards must be familiar with per BSIS training are defined in:

A. PC §836

✓ B. BPC §7583.7 — Section 631

C. Title 16 CCR §643

D. BPC §480

B

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Review

BPC §7583.7

A guard observes two persons arguing loudly near the building entrance. Neither person has made a physical threat. The BEST initial response is:

A. Call 911 immediately — loud arguments are a public safety threat

B. Walk toward both persons aggressively to establish authority

✓ C. Approach calmly, introduce yourself, and attempt verbal de-escalation

D. Stay inside and monitor via CCTV without engaging

C

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Review

BPC §7583.7 | Proportionality

A subject spits on a security guard. The guard responds with a takedown and pain compliance hold. This use of force:

A. Is clearly justified — battery occurred and the guard may respond with force

✓ B. May constitute excessive force — proportionality and totality of circumstances must be carefully evaluated

C. Is always lawful when a battery against the guard has occurred

D. Is prohibited — the guard must call police rather than use any physical response

B

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Review

BPC §7583.7 | Documentation

After every use-of-force incident without exception, a security guard must:

A. Contact their union representative before completing any paperwork

✓ C. Complete an incident report documenting circumstances, force applied, and outcome

B. Document only if injuries were sustained by any party

D. Notify the client only — internal PPO reporting is optional for minor incidents

C

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Review

BPC §7583.7 | Passing Score

The minimum passing score required to receive a BSIS Appropriate Use of Force Certificate of Completion is:

A. 70%

C. 90%

B. 80%

✓ D. 100%

D

SCORING GUIDE & INSTRUCTOR NOTES

Passing Score

100% — all 32 questions correct required per BPC §7583.7

Failed Assessment

Full retake required. Student must review all course modules before retaking.

Certificate

Issue Certificate of Completion ONLY upon 100% score. Sign, date, and retain a copy.

Record Retention

Retain each student's assessment record for duration of employment. Available to BSIS on request per Title 16 CCR §643(b).

Confidentiality

This answer key is for MACCESS INC. instructor use only. Never share with students before, during, or after assessment.

Live Scan

Live Scan integration is pending equipment acquisition. When active, completed LS records will be stored alongside training records.